

Functional English

Informative Presentation Guidelines

Fall 2023

For your upcoming project, you will be working on an **Informative Presentation**. The goal of an informative presentation is to educate the audience or to create awareness. Given that there are so many things and aspects that we are not aware of, let's consider this as an opportunity to share ideas on different things from fields like medicine, sustainability, technology, agriculture, pop culture, law and education to name a few.

With informative speeches, you have the space to explore multiple avenues of your interest. The only requirement for the speech is that you have to **bring forth a unique perspective** even if you are talking about something from History. **For example**, most of us know about the Harry Potter series. **Instead of discussing how many books there are and when they were published, bring a new aspect on board like Creation of New Words in the Harry Potter series.** If you plan to discuss a **historical event**, discuss **how it has far reaching impact** even now. There are multiple fields that can be explored. You just have to make sure that the idea development is informative, not persuasive.

Teams

You will be working in either pairs or groups of three. More than three students will NOT be allowed in a group. This will be an opportunity to learn importance of teamwork. The members will be required to delimit ONE topic of mutual interest and form a cohesive speech.

Topic Selection

- Bring an interesting and unique idea for the presentation.
- **The selected idea should be INFORMATIVE.**
- Do not pick a broad area to explore like Innovations in the Health Industry. You can **pick one innovation, or a technique** that was developed in the olden times and talk about how it is being used now.
- Selected idea should be appropriate for academic discussion.
- **You should be able to talk about that in 4:00 to 5:00 minutes (if in pairs) OR 6:00 to 7:00 minutes (if in a group of three). That means each member will have 2 minutes to speak about the topic.**
- **Topic approval is mandatory.**
- **Everyone in class should have a UNIQUE topic. This means that everyone should have a different topic.**
- **Incorporate 4-5 supporting details or evidence in your work.**

Google Sheet for Topics & Team members' record

- One of the requirements for the presentation is that everyone should have a unique topic. For that purpose, a Google Sheet will be maintained.
- Update your topics so your class fellows would know what you are working on.
- **Before updating your topics, review the topics listed to ensure that the topic is not**

repeated.

Dress Code

- Business Casual

Speech's Organization

- Team members can come up with **creative ways** to inform the audience about the chosen topic
- They can perform the hook together or present the information in the form of a documentary narration, along with the slideshow displayed behind of course.
- They can also divide the speech's different sections amongst each other
- However, they need to ensure a **smooth flow of information**. It must be prepared in a way that the **flow of information is seamless**.
- You will rely on each other for this very matter.
- The team members will be evaluated individually and as one unit too.
- Refer to the rubric to understand the evaluation criteria.

NOTE:

- In case one member is absent on the day of the presentation, the remaining member(s) will need to improvise and present the topic.
- So, each member must be familiar with the content and be prepared for any scenario that may occur
- The absentee will be graded **zero**
- **No retakes** will be conducted

Visual Aids

- **Visual aids in the form of slides are mandatory.**
- You can use any platform to design the slides.
 - PowerPoint
 - Google Slides
 - Canva etc.
- Make sure that you design balanced slides which are **not text heavy.**
- **Consistent color pallet/theme/design elements should be used.**
- If you use Canva or any other online platform to design slides, make sure that your file is compatible with the laptop used.
- **At least 8 content slides have to be designed.** This **does not** include the Name/Title and Thank You slide.
- Design minimalistic slides which just have key points written.
- **Incorporate quality visuals like pictures, illustrations and icons etc.**
- The visual aids will also be evaluated.
- Figure out how you will be handling the visual aids. **Either time them or work on them once with your friend so you do not have to say the next slide please or get a clicker remote to manage the slides.**

DELIVERING THE SPEECH

- **Have a memorable attention getter.** How you start the speech sets the tone for the rest of your work.
- Be audible and have vocal variety.
- Have a look at the recordings of your first two speeches and see key areas which you have to work on.
- **Paper reading is NOT allowed.** Understand the content that you plan to deliver, even if you forget a point you can improvise.
- Maintain eye contact with your audience.
- You will be marked for posture and use of gestures. Gestures should support and augment the idea being discussed.
- **Be confident and animated.** Just think of this as an opportunity to share enlightening ideas with your colleagues.

VIDEO RECORDING

- Hand your smartphone to your friend, so they can record your presentation.
- In the case you have any questions/objections about the marks, the recording can be used to discuss the key points.
- Do not make use of any filters (Snapchat or Instagram) while recording. Any such video will not be considered if shown for a review.
- Video recording is mandatory.